AI After ChatGPT: What 2022–2026 Means for Insights Teams

Twelve developments and why each one matters for research work

Ali Bakhareba · Adapted from Group 10's *Beyond the Chatbox* · AIML-500, Indiana Wesleyan University

THE STARTING POINT · 2022

Nov 30 2022 — **ChatGPT opens to the public** · Starting point

Analysts, clients and respondents got the same tool on the same day. Expectations for how fast insights can be turned around changed quickly, and some open-ended survey answers may now be written with AI help, which adds a new data-quality check.

WIDER ACCESS AND COMPETITION · 2023

Mar 14 2023 — **GPT-4 arrives** · Major milestone

Image input means a model can read a chart, a shelf photo or a piece of packaging. That helps desk research, but every reading still has to be checked against the source.

Jul 18 2023 — **Llama 2 expands access to model weights** · Major milestone

With downloadable weights, a team can run a model on its own systems. That matters when respondent or client data is not allowed to leave the company.

Jul 20 2023 — **Custom instructions save repetition** · Minor / incremental

A team can save its coding frame, tone or reporting rules once instead of retyping them, which makes AI-assisted work more consistent across analysts.

MEDIA, REASONING AND RULES · 2024

Feb 13 2024 — **Memory testing begins** · Minor / incremental

Convenient, but it raises a data-handling question: what client or respondent details might the tool keep? Teams need a rule before anyone pastes study data in.

Feb 15 2024 — **Sora demonstrates text-to-video** · Major milestone

Video concepts for testing may one day be produced much faster. The preview-versus-launch difference matters: research teams often hear about a tool long before they can use it.

May 13 2024 — **GPT-4o brings text, vision and audio together** · Major milestone

Real-time voice opens the door to AI-moderated interviews. The same caution applies as with any moderator: check what the system actually captured.

Aug 1 2024 — **The EU AI Act enters into force** · Major milestone

Teams working with EU customers or data need to know which risk category their AI use falls into and what transparency it requires.

Sep 12 2024 — **o1-preview emphasizes reasoning** · Major milestone

Helpful for multi-step analysis questions, such as checking the logic of a segmentation, but each step still needs a human check.

Nov 25 2024 — **The Model Context Protocol is introduced** · Major milestone

Assistants can now be connected to the places research data lives, such as files, databases and dashboards. That saves copying and pasting, but it makes access permissions a research-governance issue.

REASONING, TASKS AND PRIVACY · 2025–2026

Aug 7 2025 — **GPT-5 combines response styles** · Major milestone

The tool now decides how hard to work on a question. Analysts should still say when they need a careful answer, and they should still verify the numbers.

Oct 20 2026 — **Locked chats begin rolling out** · Minor / incremental

A small change that shows privacy is now a product feature. It limits who can open a chat on a shared device; it does not replace a team's own rules on what data goes into AI tools.

Sources: OpenAI (2022, 2023a, 2023b, 2024a–d, 2025, 2026); Meta (2023); European Commission (2024); Anthropic (2024); Siddiqui et al. (2026). Full APA 7 references in the online version of this artifact.